Board 1
South Deals
None Vul

♠ A 10 2
♥ A J 7
♦ J 8 6 2
♣ K 6 5

♠ 8 7 5 4 3
♥ Q 10 3
♦ A 4
♣ J 10 3

♠ J 6
♥ 9 8 5 2
♦ 9 7 5
♣ A Q 9 8

♠ K Q 9
♥ K 6 4
♦ K Q 10 3
♣ 7 4 2

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1♦
Pass	2NT	Pass	3NT
All Pass			

3NT by North
Lead: ♥9

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥9, the top of nothing.

Your ♣s are so good that all your instincts tell you to lead the ♣8, and perhaps set up 3 winners.

If you had one more small ♣s your instincts would be right, but with only a 4-card suit you should think a little longer. Three tricks won't set this contract, so you must depend on partner winning something. And if partner is going to win something perhaps he will lead a ♣ and you might make FOUR tricks in the suit.

So lead the ♥9. You lead a high card so partner won't be tempted to return the suit when he gets the lead. Note that although this lead finesses partner's ♥Q, it didn't do anything that declarer wouldn't have done on his own.

Declarer must play ♦s to get some winners, and when West takes the ♦A he will surely switch to the ♣J. Down goes declarer.

Board 2
North Deals
N-S Vul

	♠ 5 ♥ K Q 9 6 3 ♦ K 6 ♣ K Q 10 9 6	
♠ K 10 8 ♥ 7 ♦ A 7 5 3 2 ♣ 8 5 3 2	N W E S	♠ Q J 9 7 6 2 ♥ A 8 5 4 ♦ 4 ♣ 7 4
	♠ A 4 3 ♥ J 10 2 ♦ Q J 10 9 8 ♣ A J	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
	1♥	2♠	3♦
3♠	4♣	Pass	4♥
Pass	Pass	4♠	Dbl
All Pass			

4♠X by East
Lead: ♠A

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 4♠ doubled

Lead the ♠A.

East's 2♠ bid is a Weak-jump Overcall, based on a 6-card ♠ suit and a weak hand.

Either the ♦Q or ♥J would normally be good leads.

But on this deal West/East have clearly sacrificed against your almost certain ♥ game. Since they don't have enough high-card strength to make this contract declarer is hoping to get some ruffs.

The way to cut down the number of ruffs he can make is to lead a trump at every opportunity.

So take the ♠A and then play another ♠. Declarer will still be able to ruff one ♥ in dummy, but will be left with two losing ♥s and will be down 2. Without the two trump plays he could have ruffed all three of his ♥ losers and actually made the conract.

Board 3
South Deals
None Vul

♠ 10 6 4
♥ 6 4 2
♦ K 9 4 2
♣ A K J

♠ K 8 7 3
♥ Q 10 7 3
♦ 7 5
♣ 6 3 2

♠ Q 9 2
♥ K 8 5
♦ A 8 6
♣ 10 9 7 5

♠ A J 5
♥ A J 9
♦ Q J 10 3
♣ Q 8 4

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
			1NT
Pass	3NT		
All Pass			

3NT by South
Lead: ♥3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 3NT

Lead the ♥3, fourth highest in an attacking suit.

Sometimes it comes down to just this kind of choice. Do you lead fourth down from ♠ K 8 7 3 or from ♥ Q 10 7 3.

The presence of the ♥10 bolsters the ♥ suit enough to give it the edge.

The suits could be arranged something like shown at left. With a ♠ lead the presence of the ♠10 in dummy allows declarer to make a second ♠ trick, which happens to be declarer's ninth trick.

But when you lead the ♥3 it does not promote a ♥ winner for declarer, and left to his own devices, he cannot establish the ♠ winner.

Board 4
East Deals
Both Vul

	♠ 6 3 ♥ K 6 3 ♦ A 7 4 ♣ 10 9 8 7 4	
♠ K Q J 9 5 4 ♥ A J 10 ♦ 6 ♣ A 5 2		♠ A 10 ♥ 9 4 ♦ K Q J 9 8 3 ♣ K Q J
	♠ 8 7 2 ♥ Q 8 7 5 2 ♦ 10 5 2 ♣ 6 3	

West	*North*	*East*	*South*
		1♦	Pass
1♠	Pass	3♦	Pass
3♠	Pass	4♠	Pass
4NT[1]	Pass	5♦[2]	Pass
6♠			
All Pass			

1. Blackwood
2. 1 ace

6♠ by West
Lead: ♥3

The bidding has been as shown. The contract is 6♠

Lead the ♥3.

The ♣10 would probably be a very safe lead. But you don't want "safe", you want "attack".

Dummy has advertised a long, strong ♦ suit which declarer will no doubt establish for discards.

It is important for your side to create a winner before your ♦A is forced out. The most likely looking winner is your ♥K. So lead the small ♥ and hope partner has the Queen.